



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

Date: May 26, 2026	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	• Who: An organized group of unethical hackers • What: A ransomware security incident • Where: At a health care company • When: Tuesday 9:00 a.m. • Why: The incident happened because unethical hackers were able to access the company's systems using a phishing attack. After gaining access, the attackers launched their ransomware on the company's systems, encrypting critical files. The attackers' motivation appears to be financial because the ransom note they left demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.
Additional notes	1. How could the health care company prevent an incident like this from occurring again? To prevent future occurrences, the clinic should implement robust email filtering solutions to block malicious attachments. Additionally, they must conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training so employees can recognize phishing attempts. Finally, maintaining routine, offline data backups and implementing the principle of least privilege will limit the damage if a breach occurs. 2. Should the company pay the ransom to retrieve the decryption key? No, the company should generally avoid paying the ransom. Paying does not guarantee that the attackers will actually provide the decryption key, it encourages future attacks, and it funds criminal organizations. Instead, the company should report the incident to law enforcement authorities (like the FBI or CISA) and restore their systems using secure backups.

